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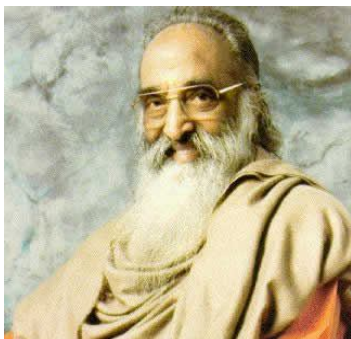


THE IB NEWSLETTER OF THE CHINMAYA INTERNATIONAL RESIDENTIAL SCHOOL

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January 2010

26th January 2010 — A day with a difference



Faith is "to believe what you do not see", the reward of which is, "you see what you believed"

- Swami Chinmayananda,
founder of the Chinmaya
International Residential
School

The 61st Republic Day will always be etched in our memories. For us, the First Year IB class, 26th January celebrations did not end with the morning march past.

As part of our CAS activity we went to participate in the celebrations of the Government sponsored Tribal School in the Siruvani forests. We planned to organize drawing and singing competitions for the students. Children aged from three to twelve watched us with shy but curious smiles until we went around distributing the drawing material we had brought along with us.

The drawing competition was a great revelation. That given a chance creativity flows was another learning: such fascinating pictures of the flag, of nature, of the daily vegetables. There was a lot of enthusiasm for the patriotic song competition and a lot of cheering for the winners.

The interaction also brought forward the physical deformities of Jairam and Chinnasamy, both around three years of age. Enquiries revealed that some treatment could help. The sudden determination in all our faces, the promise in all our eyes was indicative of how touched we were. We decided to take this up as our project and try and see how we could facilitate these children so that they could best adjust to the main stream of life.

When it was time to leave we were a determined lot, we would have to help Jairam and Chinnasamy. We hoped to be able to serve more people in need.

- Roshni and Pooja, IB first year

Inside this issue ...

Page 1

A day with a difference

Page 2

Pongal Celebration

Page 3

Srilanka trip

SAIBSA job-alike session

Page 4

Success in IB exams



Pongal Celebration

Ever heard about an ABCD American Born Confused Desi? I am the living example. Born and brought up in the US, with my parents trying their best to keep me abreast with the Indian customs and culture, I came to CIRS thinking I knew it all. But I learnt that more than India being a land of festivals, it was as if all the festivals of the world landed in India. Today I will tell you about this wonderful festival we celebrated on January 14, called Pongal.

I learnt that the celebration was for the reaping of a good harvest. The day began with a puja after which Swami Swaroopanandaji distributed the clay pots. These pots were artfully painted the previous day by us. This pot would have to be wrapped around the neck by a tamarind plant and then placed on an open fire and PONGAL was to be cooked in it.

Cooking is not exactly my forte, and an open fire cooking is not something that I would remotely associate myself with. But here I was washing the rice, lighting the fire, and crying tears of fun and laughter as the wood smoke singed my eyes. It was a spectacle like no other I had seen. There was colour everywhere, from the dazzling dresses and glittering trinkets of the girls, the flashy kurtas of the boys to the rangoli's that were being designed!!! Every one was smiling and while only some were actually involved in

the cooking there was so much of team spirit.

And as the vessel overflowed with the starch water there was beating of the steel plates with spoons and shouts of "Pongal-O-Pongal" from everyone!!! Once the Pongal was made there was such a feeling of achievement! Many times the judges were forgotten as everyone got busy tasting the Pongal they had made. After prayers to the Sun God to whom the Pongal we had made was offered, we had a grand lunch on banana leaves.

The evening was reserved for another very interesting feature of the day - flying kites. I am sure it has some significance but have not yet discovered it. Not that I tried too hard as I was so engrossed in watching the kites of so many different colours soar into the sky. There were some who were champion kite fliers, competing for the supremacy of the skies, also some who were learning to fly a kite. But the best sight was offered by the little toddlers who ran all around with the kites trailing behind them. Later in the day we had a special Aarti and saw a presentation of the day's events.

After such a fabulous experience, I am already counting days for the next Pongal.

Namrata Dayana - I year IB



Srilanka Trip

True to the spirit of the IBO that promotes experiential learning, CIRS for the first time organized an overseas CAS project at Srilanka which was successfully completed. The task was to renovate a Hindu temple that belonged to plantation workers.

It was a memorable opportunity for the first year IB students to be involved in the renovation work which exposed them to the various skills of masonry. Some students visited the local school and interacted with the children of elementary classes. Before leaving, the IB students handed over some financial aid to sustain the renovation project that they had begun.

The significant aspect of this pro-

ject was the interaction between the plantation workers and the IB students that paved the way for a good intercultural understanding. The necessity for peaceful co-existence of diverse communities was well understood by the students.

The rest of the tour gave the students an ample chance to witness and appreciate the Srilankan tradition and heritage. The visits to Polonnaruwa ruins, Pinnawela elephant orphanage and Kandy Tooth Relic temple were academically enriching. Without doubt, the fun and learning of the Srilanka trip would remain permanently etched in the memory of the first year IB students.



SAIBSA job-alike session

The IB Diploma job-alike session for this year was conducted at the Indus International School, Bangalore on 30th January 2010 for all the IB schools of South India .

This year 8 IB teachers from the Chinmaya International Residential School participated at the session. The job-alike session provides a platform for the practicing IB teachers to share their experi-

ences and best practices with the teachers of other schools. Specific sessions are conducted for CAS, TOK and Extended Essay.

The following teachers facilitated the Biology, Physics and Business & Management sessions respectively.

Mrs.Jaya Ravi Sankar,
Mr.Venkatragavaraj and
Mrs.Annapoorni

JUST A JOKE . . .



THOUGHT PROVOKING



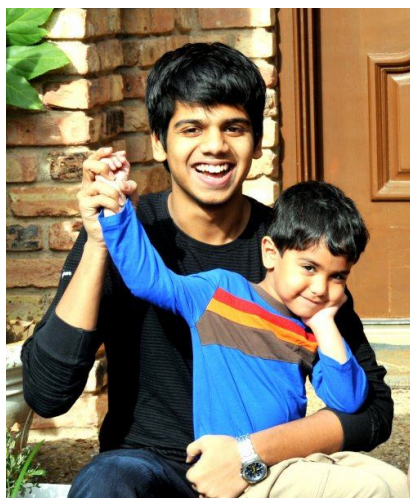
DINGBAT PUZZLE



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Alumni speaks - Success in IB exams



Six students from the first year IB class took the SAT test on 23rd January 2010 at the Kodai International School. We congratulate them for their first step towards international graduate program.

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To succeed in any examination, there must be a motivation and drive to achieve. This is especially true for IB where a student might have to face approximately fifteen exams, sometimes three exams on the same day. Here are a few tips that should make some difference.

The first requirement in IB is to understand the subject content clearly. It does not help to memorize them. An easy approach to exam would be to try and solve the questions in the IB question bank. Most questions that one faces in the IB exam are usually similar to the ones in the question bank. With adequate preparation and repeated practice, it is easy to handle the IB exam.

When preparing for exams, it is better to study in groups of three and to refrain from involving in long late night conversations with friends. During the days of the preparation for the exam it is necessary to feel relaxed and also avoid being unnecessarily distracted.

Before the days of the exam, students should not exert themselves too much and after the exam it is not advisable to discuss the answers. It is not going to help especially when a mistake in the current exam is identified. This may even affect the performance in the other forthcoming exams.

Get enough sleep. Adequate sleep the previous night helps easy recall of facts and concepts from memory during the exam.

As the use of a calculator is inevitable for most IB subjects, a clear understanding of all the functions of the calculator is essential. One has to be efficient in using the calculator. Use the Casio FX-9860G or any other calculator that is recommended by the IBO.

Answers must be legibly written. Examiners are not obliged to read an answer that is not readable and this may result in the candidate being penalized. All questions should be attempted as there is no negative marking. Answers need to be specific and well organized. It is important to bring the necessary stationary and have them organized for quick access. Borrowing of materials is not allowed during the exams.

Good Luck!!!

"First say to yourself what you would be, and then do what you have to do." Epictetus

Vineet Desai

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